A major objective of the other BRICS members, especially for neighbors India and Russia, is to bind China within the BRICS club. The relationship between Russia and China has vastly improved in recent years, and their strong and multistranded bilateral relations cement the core of the BRICS club. Yet, while the club was intended to be one of Moscow's geopolitical instruments to bind China, it has not been very successful in this goal, as China has surpassed Russia to become the principal U.S. partner and challenger. China has also undercut Russia in Eurasia, while Moscow has failed to get the ruble or the NDB accepted as the dominant financial statecraft instrument, with China moving fast on RMB internationalization, as well as in establishing the AIIB and OBOR program.

For India, whose rivalry and tension with Pakistan and China dominate its foreign policy concerns, it is important to try to use the BRICS club to balance China and the West strategically. The other two members, Brazil and South Africa, have no ambition (or need) to restrain China's geopolitical actions, but they aim to ride the economic wave with China in the expectation of expanding trade and investment relations with their powerful compatriot.

In sum, these five countries, though dissimilar in both their material power capabilities and strategic and international economic goals, have surprisingly found common cause in the BRICS club, whose most active and successful initiatives have involved collective financial statecraft. This chapter has examined each country's individual motives for collaboration. The final chapter of this book explores the potential directions of and complications for future BRICS collaborations.